VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

# THE SPACEX DISPATCH

*Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock*

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 29, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF WED OCT 28 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

## Musk: Ship 42 will be the first ship caught by the tower

"Ship 42 static fires complete," SpaceX posted at 12:10 p.m. EDT Wednesday. "The Starship preparing for Flight 15 performed a full duration, six-engine static fire, and fired a single Raptor engine to simulate a deorbit burn." Quoting the post at 10:37 p.m., Elon Musk wrote: "As the prophecy foretold, Starship 42 will be the first tower catch."

Ship 42 left the Massey's test site that night and was moved along Highway 4 back to the production site, Tracking The Starbase posted at 11:15 p.m., and was "back in the barn" by 2:01 a.m. Thursday (post). SpaceX has not announced a date for Flight 15, which Launch Library 2 lists for no earlier than November from Pad 2 at Starbase.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

## Starfall delivers Air Force cargo from orbit

*AFRL recovered its cargo pods after the capsule, launched on Bandwagon-5, splashed down in the Pacific.*



A Super Heavy booster beside the launch tower at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

The Air Force Research Laboratory recovered cargo pods that flew to orbit and back inside SpaceX's Starfall capsule, which launched on the Bandwagon-5 Falcon 9 mission from Cape Canaveral on October 20 and splashed down in the Pacific Ocean, Space.com reported. "With support from SpaceX, the AFRL agile cargo pods were recovered after splashdown in the Pacific Ocean," AFRL said in an October 26 post.

"This was a critical achievement to demonstrate the potential of Rocket Cargo delivery for point-to-point rapid global mobility for the Future Force," said AFRL's Adam Remaly. The pods carried temperature, shock and vibration sensors along with medical equipment, ration packs, a satellite-linked tracker, batteries, a reverse-osmosis desalinator and survival gear, and AFRL fit-checked a life raft in the capsule (Space.com).

Starfall, which debuted in June, is about 3.1 meters (10.2 feet) across and can return up to 1,000 kilograms (2,200 pounds), with a carbon-fiber heat shield, cold-gas thrusters and parachutes, according to an FAA environmental assessment cited by Space.com. AFRL's separate plan to test Starship cargo landings on Johnston Atoll was suspended in July 2025. The Verge also covered the recovery.

### "No need to paint stainless"

Replying to a Dwarkesh Podcast clip on Starship's stainless-steel construction, Musk wrote at 2:20 a.m. EDT Thursday: "Also, no need to paint stainless. Paint adds more mass & cost."

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

# Starlink 15-18 slips a day; USSF-432 moves to Monday

*Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next five weeks, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern: EDT through November 1, EST after.*

| DATE / TIME (EDT/EST) | VEHICLE | MISSION | PAD | STATUS | SOURCES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fri Oct 30, 11:48 p.m. EDT | Falcon 9 | Starlink 15-18, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1093, 18th flight; landing on Of Course I Still Love You. **Moved** from 12:02 a.m. EDT Fri Oct 30; no reason given | SLC-4E, Vandenberg | Confirmed | SpaceX; Launch Library 2 |
| Mon Nov 2, 8:42 p.m. EST | Falcon 9 | USSF-432, U.S. Space Force. **Moved** from Sun Nov 1, 8:56 p.m. EST, the earlier backup date; no reason given | SLC-4E, Vandenberg | Confirmed | SpaceX; Launch Library 2 |
| Thu Nov 5, 11:59 p.m. EST | Falcon 9 | Starlink 15-21, 27 V2 Mini satellites. **Moved** from Wed Nov 4, 9:35 p.m. EST; no reason given. Launch Library 2 lists 9:21 p.m. | SLC-4E, Vandenberg | Tentative | FAA; Launch Library 2 |
| Mon Nov 9, 10:03 p.m. EST | Falcon 9 | U.S. Space Force mission "R-5." **New** to the schedule | SLC-4E, Vandenberg | Tentative | Launch Library 2 |
| November | Starship | Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; ship static fires complete Oct 28 | Pad 2, Starbase, Texas | Preliminary | SpaceX; Launch Library 2 |
| November | Falcon 9 | NROL-195, National Reconnaissance Office | SLC-4E, Vandenberg | Preliminary | Launch Library 2 |
| November | Falcon 9 | OneWeb 21 for Eutelsat OneWeb. **New** to the schedule | SLC-4E, Vandenberg | Preliminary | Launch Library 2 |
| November | Falcon 9 | Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS | SLC-40, Cape Canaveral | Preliminary | Launch Library 2 |
| Later | Starship | Flight 16, Ship 43 and Booster 23; first Starship launch from Florida | LC-39A, Kennedy | Preliminary | NASASpaceflight (unofficial) |

*Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) date or month, or an unofficial target. Changes since Wednesday's issue: Starlink 15-18 now opens its window at 11:48 p.m. EDT Friday, nearly 24 hours later than listed; USSF-432 moved from Sunday to Monday; Starlink 15-21 moved a day later, to late Thursday, November 5, with an FAA airspace window opening at 11:59 p.m. EST (FAA); the "R-5" mission and OneWeb 21 were added (Launch Library 2). No reasons were given for the changes. No SpaceX launches since Wednesday's issue.*

III · STARLINK

# Starlink keeps phones working after Spain's train crash

*Movistar and Orange customers near the collision site can text and use apps through satellites while towers are down.*



A train of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky over Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.
PHOTO: DKTUE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0 (CROPPED)

"Starlink Mobile is providing free connectivity to @orange_es and @Telefonica customers affected by the devastating train collision in Spain," Starlink posted at 7:37 p.m. EDT Wednesday. "Families, communities, and businesses with compatible LTE phones can stay connected via apps and texts even when cell towers are down."

The collision on Wednesday between a Renfe AVE and an Iryo train on the Madrid–Seville high-speed line near Urda, in the province of Toledo, Movistar and Orange switched on Starlink service in the area under an authorization from Telecom Castilla-La Mancha to use its frequencies, ADSLZone reported. The carriers did the same during this summer's wildfires near Madrid. El Español also reported the activation.

"We're supporting communities in Spain with @Starlink Mobile during this difficult time," SpaceX's Stephanie Bednarek posted at 9:37 p.m. Musk replied: "Standard practice."

### Pentagon watchdog declines Ukraine review

The Defense Department's inspector general, Platte Moring, declined a request from nine senators of both parties, led by

Thom Tillis and Jeanne Shaheen, to investigate slowdowns of Starshield and Starlink service in Ukraine, saying the Air Force and Space Force were better placed to review it, CNN reported Wednesday. Speeds were fully restored on Saturday, according to the report.

QUICK HIT

**Amazon's biggest batch.** All 40 Amazon Leo satellites are integrated for the first launch on United Launch Alliance's six-booster Vulcan, "our largest payload to date," Amazon Leo posted; ULA targets Friday, Nov. 13, pending range approval.

IV · AI & COMPUTE

# A referral program for Grok Bot

*Invited users get a two-week Premium trial; Musk says he has Grok Bot shop around for lower prices.*

SpaceX introduced a referral program for Grok Bot under which an invited friend gets a two-week free trial of Premium and the referrer gets a free usage reset, valid for six months, Sawyer Merritt posted at 3:50 p.m. EDT Wednesday.

"Amazon locked out my Grok Bot. So it just bought the same thing from a different site (at a lower price)," James Douma posted at 10:00 p.m. "That's what I do too. Just have @Bot buy it somewhere else at a lower price," Musk replied at 10:30 p.m. When Shopify's Tobi Lütke replied "Just in time for shop pay support," Musk quoted him: "Buy from @Shopify!"

ON THE WIRE

**Two-week trial.** Friends invited through the new Grok Bot referral program get two weeks of Premium free, Sawyer Merritt posted.

V · FILINGS: SEC, FAA & FCC

# The FCC votes on satellite-to-phone spectrum

*No new SEC filings; the commission takes up 482 MHz for Supplemental Coverage from Space at 10:30 a.m. EDT Thursday.*

## SEC

**None new** — No SpaceX filings on EDGAR since the 8-K accepted at 8:00 a.m. EDT Monday.

## FAA

**Nov 30 · Starbase PEIS** — Scoping comments due on the Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement for more Starship-Super Heavy operations at Starbase (docket FAA-2026-12808); public meetings Nov 17–19. Federal Register

BY THE NUMBERS

| | |
|---|---|
| **482** | MHz the FCC votes on Thursday for Supplemental Coverage from Space (FCC) |
| **1,000** | kilograms Starfall can return from orbit (Space.com) |
| **18th** | flight for booster B1093 on Starlink 15-18 (SpaceX) |

## FCC

**Oct 29 · Open meeting** — 482 MHz more for Supplemental Coverage from Space (GN Dockets 26-281, 23-65); 25 MHz auction proposal. FCC

**Nov 4 · Surety bond** — Due under the October 6 order granting 15,000 Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in part. Exterra

**Nov 25 · Space Modernization** — Comments due on the further notice of proposed rulemaking (SB Docket No. 25-306); replies Dec 28. Federal Register

## Takeaways

1. Ship 42 finished its static fires; Musk said it will be the first ship caught by the tower.
2. AFRL recovered cargo pods flown on SpaceX's Starfall capsule.
3. Starlink 15-18 slipped to 11:48 p.m. EDT Friday; USSF-432 moved to Monday.
4. Starlink is keeping phones connected after a train collision in Spain.
5. The FCC votes Thursday on 482 MHz for satellite-to-phone service.
6. SPCX fell 2.25% to $145.23.

SOURCES

Posts by @SpaceX, @elonmusk, @TrackingTheSB, @efraser77, @dwarkeshpodcast, @Starlink, @SRBednarek, @AmazonLeo, @ulalaunch, @SawyerMerritt, @jamesdouma, @tobi and @NASASpaceflight on X; Space.com; The Verge; ADSLZone; El Español; CNN; SpaceX; Launch Library 2; FCC, Federal Register, Exterra; SEC EDGAR and prospectus; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: Wikimedia Commons (Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0; Dktue, CC0).

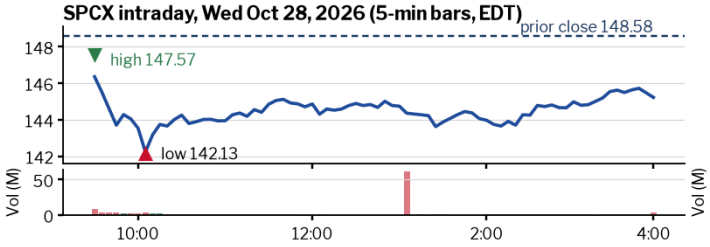
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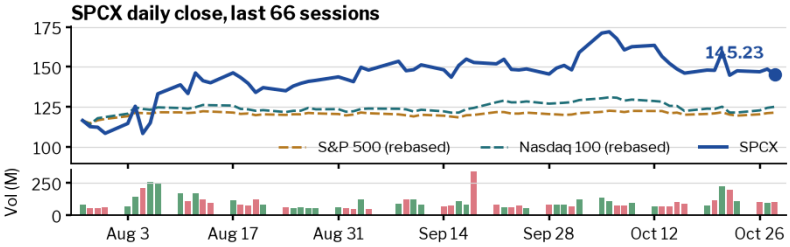
# Down 2.3% to $145.23

*SPCX fell on Wednesday on volume 4.6% below its 30-session average, while the Nasdaq 100 rose 0.55% and Rocket Lab, AST SpaceMobile and Iridium all gained.*

| CLOSE | CHANGE | OPEN | DAY HIGH | DAY LOW |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $145.23 | −$3.35 | $147.37 | $148.20 | $142.13 |
| *Wed Oct 28, 4:00 p.m. EDT* | *−2.25% vs $148.58* | *regular session* | *9:30 a.m. EDT bar* | *10:05 a.m. EDT bar* |
| **VOLUME** | **RANGE SINCE IPO** | **MARKET CAP** | **5-DAY / 1-MONTH** | **SINCE LISTING** |
| 98.24M | $105–$226 | $1.97T | −8.8% / −2.7% | +7.6% |
| *−4.6% vs 30-session avg 102.96M* | *no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)* | *13.58B Class A+B shares (Oct 15) × close* | *5 and 21 sessions* | *vs $135 IPO price; −9.77% vs first close* |

**SINCE IPO** — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $145.23 | high $225.64 · Jun 16; 50-day avg $149.46




As of close Oct 28, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

## RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 28 CLOSE

| TICKER | 1-DAY | 5-DAY | 1-MONTH | SINCE JUN 12 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SPCX** | **−2.25%** | **−8.84%** | **−2.69%** | **−9.77%** |
| S&P 500 | +0.28% | −0.17% | +0.95% | +4.21% |
| Nasdaq 100 | +0.55% | −0.03% | −1.73% | +0.60% |
| RKLB | +0.50% | +9.19% | −15.93% | −42.77% |
| ASTS | +0.81% | +3.42% | −28.79% | −48.67% |
| IRDM | +0.64% | +3.82% | −4.17% | −2.92% |

## OPTIONS (CBOE, WED OCT 28 CLOSE)

| EXPIRY | CALL OI | PUT OI | P/C | ATM IV | TOP CALL / PUT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Oct 30 | 287,148 | 205,679 | 0.72 | 59.5% | $160 / $150 |
| Nov 2 | 27,254 | 15,763 | 0.58 | 45.9% | $157.5 / $145 |
| Nov 4 | 10,686 | 7,414 | 0.69 | 50.6% | $160 / $135 |
| Nov 6 | 127,800 | 82,932 | 0.65 | 51.9% | $175 / $140 |
| **All expiries** | **2,597,315** | **2,520,506** | **0.97** | | **30-day IV index 48.8** |

## ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 29

| | |
|---|---|
| Strong buy | 8 |
| Buy | 23 |
| Hold | 6 |
| Sell | 2 |
| Strong sell | 0 |
| Mean (1 = strong buy) | 1.72 |
| Mean target (36 analysts) | $257.11 (+77.0%) |
| Median target | $247.50 |
| High / low target | $800.00 / $70.00 |

## SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

| | |
|---|---|
| Short interest, Oct 15 | 167.29M |
| Change vs. prior report | +3.1% |
| Short % of float | 2.44% |
| Days to cover | 1.79 |
| Held by insiders | 12.49% |
| Held by institutions | 47.13% |
| Alphabet, Jun 30 | 6.68% |
| Valor Management, Jun 30 | 6.10% |

## VALUATION & TREND · OCT 28 CLOSE

| | |
|---|---|
| Trailing P/E (EPS $0.23) | 631.4 |
| Forward P/E (est. $2.37) | 61.4 |
| Price/sales (rev. $32.04B) | 61.6 |
| Beta | — |
| 50-day average | $149.46 (−2.8%) |
| 200-day average | — |
| 10-day avg. volume | 120.67M |
| 3-month avg. volume | 102.01M |

## RECENT RATING ACTIONS

| DATE | FIRM | RATING | TARGET |
|---|---|---|---|
| Oct 22 | Bank of America | Buy | $235 to $275 |
| Oct 22 | Pivotal Research | Buy | $230 to $260 |
| Oct 21 | JPMorgan | Overweight | $240 to $500 |
| Oct 21 | Evercore ISI | Outperform | $275 to $300 |
| Oct 21 | Barclays | Overweight | $254 to $300 |
| Oct 21 | Wells Fargo | Overweight | $214 to $274 |
| Oct 21 | Susquehanna | Neutral | $173 to $176 |

## CATALYST CALENDAR

| DATE | EVENT |
|---|---|
| **Thu Oct 29** | **FCC open meeting: 482 MHz D2D vote** |
| Fri Oct 30 | Weekly options expiry (287,148 calls open) |
| Mon Nov 2 | USSF-432 launch from Vandenberg |
| Wed Nov 4 | FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites) |
| Wed Nov 25 | FCC space-modernization comments due |
| Mon Nov 30 | FAA Starbase PEIS scoping comments due |
| Tue Dec 8 | 180-day lock-up ends (remaining 797.6M) |
| By year end | $40B GPU lease expected to close |

*Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Oct 15), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Oct 29. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; OI, IV at Wednesday's close; ATM IV at $145. Shares: 10-Q cover. IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4). Lease: 8-K. FCC dates: Federal Register, Exterra, FCC.*